

Meridian Financial Product Catalog

Reference PRD-2027-A. Owner: Product Management. Effective 2027-01-15. This catalog describes Meridian Financial Group's client-facing and member-facing products, their commercial terms, and their operational boundaries. Internal platform components (Vireo Clearing Hub, Halcyon) are included for completeness but are not sold separately.

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1 Product family overview

Meridian operates six named products. Client-facing products are sold by Commercial; member-facing products are contracted through Network Participation under the onboarding process ONB-2026-K.

Product	Code	Audience	Commercial owner
Kestrel Instant Settlement Network (KSN)	PRD-KSN	Member institutions	Network Participation
Aviary member portal	PRD-AVY	Member institutions	Network Participation
Tern FX currency desk	PRD-TFX	Corporate and SME clients	Commercial
Sunbird payments wallet	PRD-SNB	SME and retail clients	Commercial
Vireo Clearing Hub	PRD-VCH	Internal platform	Payments Operations
Halcyon ledger and reconciliation	PRD-HAL	Internal platform	Payments Operations

2 Kestrel Instant Settlement Network

Kestrel is the group's real-time interbank settlement rail, governed by policy KSN-2027-A. Member institutions settle under a Kestrel Participant Identifier (KPI) in one of three participation tiers. Card, cheque, and legacy ACH-equivalent flows are out of Kestrel scope and remain under PAY-2025-C.

2.1 Participation tiers and limits

Tier	Name	Single-instruction ceiling	Rolling 24h limit
Tier-K1	Anchor	No cap	No cap
Tier-K2	Direct	8,000,000 KES-eq	Not applied
Tier-K3	Indirect (via K2 sponsor)	750,000 KES-eq	40,000,000 KES-eq

2.2 Settlement fees

Fees are billed monthly in arrears against the participant's Vireo funding account. Rejected instructions are not billed.

Tier	Fee model	Waiver
Tier-K1	Flat 4,200 units per month, unlimited volume	Not applicable
Tier-K2	0.9 units per instruction	Waived above 1,000,000 monthly instructions
Tier-K3	2.5 units per instruction	No waiver

2.3 Service levels

Settlement finality targets: 4 seconds in the prime window (05:00-22:00 EAT) and 30 seconds off-peak. The quarterly freeze (last business day of quarter, 23:00-23:45 EAT) queues all non-K1 instructions during

the Halcyon end-of-quarter reconciliation. Detailed error-handling rules, including the KSN-ERR code ranges, are in KSN-2027-A section 4 and the Kestrel API changelog CHG-KSN.

3 Aviary member portal

Aviary is the web portal through which member institutions manage their Kestrel participation: KPI lifecycle management, settlement statements, sandbox (KPI-S) self-service, and support tickets.

3.1 Support entitlements

Participant tier	Support response SLA	Channel
Tier-K1	Dedicated channel, no ticket queue	Named contact
Tier-K2	4 business hours	Aviary ticket
Tier-K3	Next business day	Aviary ticket

3.2 Sandbox access

Since release v2026.3 of the Kestrel API, integrators self-request a sandbox KPI (KPI-S) through Aviary once onboarding milestone M2 is signed off. A KPI-S expires after 90 days of inactivity (changed from 180 days in v2027.2) and is re-issued through Aviary without a support ticket.

4 Tern FX currency desk

Tern FX provides spot and forward foreign exchange in East African Community currencies to corporate and SME clients.

4.1 Dealing terms

- Same-day value cutoff: 15:30 EAT for EAC currency pairs; later trades book for next business day.
- Forward tenors: up to 12 months, subject to credit approval by the Tern desk.
- Minimum ticket: 250,000 KES-eq spot; 1,000,000 KES-eq forwards.
- Standard spread schedule: reference TFX-SPREAD-2027, published monthly on Aviary.

4.2 Compliance boundaries

Tern FX client relationships follow the AML client-tier framework in AML-2024-B. Note that AML client tiers (tier-1 institutional, tier-2 SME, tier-3 retail) are a different axis from Kestrel participation tiers: a tier-2 SME client of Tern FX has no Kestrel tier at all unless their bank is separately a Kestrel member.

5 Sunbird payments wallet

Sunbird is Meridian's mobile-first payments wallet for SMEs and retail users.

5.1 Wallet limits

Account state	Daily transaction cap	Single transaction cap
Verified	500,000 KES	150,000 KES
Unverified	50,000 KES	10,000 KES

5.2 Merchant terms

Merchant acceptance fee: 0.65% per transaction, settled to the merchant's Sunbird float account on T+1. Merchants above 2,000,000 KES monthly volume qualify for the negotiated schedule SNB-M2 and next-day dedicated support.

6 Internal platforms

Two platform components appear throughout member and client documentation but are not commercial products: they cannot be bought, and their service levels are expressed only through the products that run on them.

6.1 Vireo Clearing Hub

Vireo hosts participant funding accounts and executes Kestrel settlement windows. Participant-visible behavior (window times, error semantics) is documented in KSN-2027-A; continuity arrangements are in BCP-2026-M.

6.2 Halcyon

Halcyon is the ledger of record: audit trail, end-of-quarter reconciliation, and clawback processing. Instructions and finality timestamps are retained for seven years. Raw ledger access requires dual authorization from Payments Operations and Internal Audit; aggregated statistics publish monthly as KSN-STAT.

7 Instruction lifecycle

Every Kestrel instruction passes through five stages, in order: submission (schema validation, rate-limit check against the v2027.2 limits), sanctions screening (SCR-2026-A rules, before the settlement queue), queueing in the Vireo hub, settlement inside the active window, and finality (durable Halcyon write, then the participant-visible finality timestamp). The stage a failure occurs in determines the error family: schema and limit failures return 4xx codes at submission; compliance holds return KSN-ERR-451 at screening; hub faults return 5xx codes from queueing onward.

Integrators frequently misattribute screening holds to hub faults. The distinguishing signal is the code family: a KSN-ERR-451 hold never auto-replays, while a KSN-ERR-503 always does. Support staff triage against this table before opening an incident.

8 Regional availability

Availability is governed by licensing per EAC member state. "Full" means the product is sold and supported; "partner" means delivery through a licensed local partner institution; a dash means not available.

Product	Kenya	Uganda	Tanzania	Rwanda
Kestrel participation	Full	Full	Full	Partner
Aviary	Full	Full	Full	Partner
Tern FX	Full	Full	Partner	Partner

Product	Kenya	Uganda	Tanzania	Rwanda
Sunbird	Full	Partner	-	-

Sunbird's Tanzania and Rwanda launches are gated on wallet-interoperability rulings by the EAPC; the product council reviews the gating decision quarterly.

9 Worked fee examples

9.1 Tier-K2 monthly invoice

A Tier-K2 member submitting 1,400,000 instructions in a month pays for the first 1,000,000 at 0.9 units each (900,000 units) and nothing for the remaining 400,000 — the waiver in section 2.2 applies above the millionth instruction. Rejected instructions, including KSN-ERR-402 splits that were re-submitted successfully, are excluded from the count.

9.2 Tier-K3 monthly invoice

A Tier-K3 member submitting 30,000 instructions pays 75,000 units (30,000 x 2.5); no waiver tier exists for K3. Instructions rejected at the 750,000 KES-eq ceiling are not billed, but their split re-submissions are, as separate instructions.

9.3 Sunbird merchant settlement

A merchant processing 3,000,000 KES in a month pays 19,500 KES in acceptance fees (0.65%) and, having crossed the 2,000,000 KES threshold, qualifies for the negotiated SNB-M2 schedule the following quarter.

10 Product change control

Commercial terms in this catalog change only through the quarterly product council. Between councils, corrections are published as PRD-2027-A errata on Aviary. API-level changes follow the Kestrel API changelog CHG-KSN and its deprecation windows: deprecated endpoints receive at least one full release cycle of notice, as with the v1 instruction endpoint scheduled for sunset in v2028.1.

Appendix A - Document map

Where to look next, by topic. This catalog is the commercial entry point; the documents below are authoritative for their domains.

Topic	Authoritative document
Settlement rules, tiers, windows, error semantics	KSN-2027-A
Member onboarding, sandbox, drills, cutover	ONB-2026-K
API releases and deprecations	CHG-KSN
Sanctions screening rules and holds	SCR-2026-A
AML client tiers and transfer caps	AML-2024-B
Continuity, severities, recovery objectives	BCP-2026-M
Card, cheque, legacy ACH-equivalent flows	PAY-2025-C

Revision history

Version	Date	Change
1.0	2026-01-20	First consolidated catalog (superseded PRD-2026 sheets)
1.1	2026-07-02	Sunbird merchant schedule SNB-M2 added
2.0	2027-01-15	Current edition: Tern FX forwards, regional availability, v2027-era Kestrel limits